

ReferPeople.in

Complete Platform Transformation Guide

"Find Property. Get Loans. Land Jobs. Start Learning."

Page 1 Real Estate	Page 2 Loans	Page 3 Jobs	Page 4 Education
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Domain	referpeople.in
Stack	Django + React 19 + PostgreSQL + Redis + Nginx + AWS EKS
Deployment	AWS EKS (Kubernetes) + RDS + ElastiCache + S3 + ALB
Version	2.0 -- May 2026
Services	Real Estate Loans Jobs Higher Education

1. Platform Overview

ReferPeople.in is a multi-service platform built on top of the BRD LoanCRM codebase, transformed into four distinct service verticals all accessible from a single domain. It uses a multi-tenant architecture where Super Admins manage the entire platform, Tenant Admins (agencies, banks, employers, colleges) manage their own data, and end users can interact with all four services.

Page	URL	Service	Color
Page 1 (Home)	referpeople.in/	Real Estate -- Buy/Sell/Rent	Navy Blue
Page 2	referpeople.in/loans/	Loans -- Home Loan, LAP, Personal	Orange
Page 3	referpeople.in/jobs/	Jobs & Careers -- Listings, Apply	Purple
Page 4	referpeople.in/education/	Education -- Colleges, Admissions	Sky Blue

2. Account Hierarchy

Four-Level Account System

The platform uses a four-level user hierarchy. Every account type has different permissions and access to different parts of the platform.

Level 1 -- SUPER ADMIN

- Has unrestricted access to ALL services and ALL tenants
- Can create and delete Master Admins
- Can enable or disable entire service verticals
- Login URL: referpeople.in/super-admin/
- Default login: superadmin@referpeople.in / SuperAdmin@2024 (change immediately!)

Level 2 -- MASTER ADMIN

- Created by Super Admin, manages one or more service verticals
- Can create, approve, or suspend Tenant accounts
- Has full visibility into all Tenant data within their service
- Login URL: referpeople.in/master-admin/

Level 3 -- TENANT ADMIN

- A Real Estate Agency, Bank, Employer, or College registered on the platform
- Has their own branded dashboard with their listings, loans, jobs, or admissions
- Can create Staff Users (agents, loan officers, recruiters, counsellors) under them

- Login URL: referpeople.in/tenant/login/
- Tenant Types: AGENCY, BANK, NBFC, COMPANY, UNIVERSITY, COLLEGE

Level 4 -- NORMAL USER

- Registers via the public website
- Can search properties, apply for loans, apply for jobs, apply for admissions
- Single account works across all 4 service pages
- Login URL: referpeople.in/login/ (self-registration enabled)

3. Color Scheme & Branding

ReferPeople.in Brand Colors

The color system uses Navy Blue as the primary brand color, with Orange, Purple, and Sky Blue as service-specific accent colors. The base is Blue & White with Orange and Purple highlights mixed in.

Navy Blue (Primary)	#1A3C6E	Main brand color -- Real Estate page, navbar, CTAs
Sky Blue (Accent)	#0EA5E9	Education page color, links, highlights
Orange (Loans)	#EA580C	Loans page identity color, action buttons
Purple (Jobs)	#7C3AED	Jobs page identity color, tags, badges
Dark Navy (Background)	#0F2444	Hero sections, dark mode backgrounds
Light Gray (Cards)	#F0F4F8	Card backgrounds, secondary surfaces

CSS Variables (paste into your global CSS file)

```
:root {
  --rp-primary: #1A3C6E; /* Navy Blue -- main brand */
  --rp-accent: #0EA5E9; /* Sky Blue -- education */
  --rp-orange: #EA580C; /* Orange -- loans page */
  --rp-purple: #7C3AED; /* Purple -- jobs page */
  --rp-bg: #FFFFFF;
  --rp-text: #1F2937;
  --font-heading: 'Poppins', 'Inter', sans-serif;
  --font-primary: 'Inter', 'Segoe UI', sans-serif;
}
```

4. Service Architecture -- All 4 Pages

How the 4 Pages Connect

All 4 service pages live under one domain (referpeople.in) and are served by Nginx as a reverse proxy. Each page has its own React frontend and Django REST API backend, with a dedicated PostgreSQL database. A shared Auth service handles login across all services via JWT tokens.

Service	Backend Port	Frontend Port	Database	Container
Auth (Shared)	8000	n/a	referpeople_auth	rp_auth_backend
Real Estate	8001	3000	referpeople_realestate	rp_realestate_backend
Loans	8002	3001	referpeople_loans	rp_loans_backend
Jobs	8003	3002	referpeople_jobs	rp_jobs_backend
Education	8004	3003	referpeople_education	rp_education_backend
Master Admin	8005	3004	referpeople_masteradmin	rp_masteradmin_backend
Nginx	80/443	n/a	n/a	rp_nginx
Redis	6379	n/a	n/a	rp_redis

5. Nginx Configuration for referpeople.in

URL Routing Map

Nginx routes incoming requests to the appropriate frontend or backend based on the URL path. The config file is at: `nginx/conf.d/referpeople.conf`

URL Path	Routes To	Service
referpeople.in/	realestate-frontend:80	Real Estate Homepage
referpeople.in/api/realestate/	realestate-backend:8000/api/	Real Estate API
referpeople.in/loans/	loans-frontend:80/	Loans Page
referpeople.in/api/loans/	loans-backend:8000/api/	Loans API
referpeople.in/jobs/	jobs-frontend:80/	Jobs Page
referpeople.in/api/jobs/	jobs-backend:8000/api/	Jobs API
referpeople.in/education/	education-frontend:80/	Education Page
referpeople.in/api/education/	education-backend:8000/api/	Education API
referpeople.in/api/auth/	auth-backend:8000/api/	JWT Auth (shared)
referpeople.in/master-admin/	masteradmin-frontend:80/	Admin Panel

6. Environment Variables -- All Services

Root .env Variables (shared across all services)

```
DEBUG=False
SECRET_KEY=your-50-char-secret-key-here
ALLOWED_HOSTS=referpeople.in,www.referpeople.in

# JWT
ACCESS_TOKEN_LIFETIME_HOURS=8
REFRESH_TOKEN_LIFETIME_DAYS=1

# Redis
REDIS_URL=redis://redis:6379/0
CELERY_BROKER_URL=redis://redis:6379/1

# AWS
AWS_REGION=ap-south-1
AWS_S3_BUCKET=referpeople-media

# Email (AWS SES)
DEFAULT_FROM_EMAIL=noreply@referpeople.in
EMAIL_HOST=email-smtp.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com
```

Per-Service Database Config (example: Real Estate)

```
DB_NAME=referpeople_realestate
DB_USER=referpeople_re_user
DB_PASSWORD=your-secure-password
DB_HOST=your-rds-endpoint.ap-south-1.rds.amazonaws.com
DB_PORT=5432
```

Frontend .env (example: Real Estate Frontend)

```
VITE_API_BASE_URL=https://referpeople.in/api/realestate
VITE_AUTH_URL=https://referpeople.in/api/auth
VITE_GOOGLE_MAPS_KEY=your-google-maps-key

# Loans Frontend
VITE_API_BASE_URL=https://referpeople.in/api/loans

# Jobs Frontend
VITE_API_BASE_URL=https://referpeople.in/api/jobs

# Education Frontend
VITE_API_BASE_URL=https://referpeople.in/api/education
```

7. AWS Deployment -- Step by Step

Prerequisites -- Install These First

- AWS CLI: curl from awscli.amazonaws.com, run aws configure with ap-south-1 region
- kubectl: Download from dl.k8s.io/release/stable
- eksctl: Download from github.com/weaveworks/eksctl
- Docker: curl -fsSL <https://get.docker.com> | sh
- Terraform: Download from releases.hashicorp.com/terraform (optional)

STEP 1 -- Create ECR Repositories

```
aws ecr create-repository --repository-name referpeople/realestate-backend --region ap-south-1
aws ecr create-repository --repository-name referpeople/loans-backend --region ap-south-1
aws ecr create-repository --repository-name referpeople/jobs-backend --region ap-south-1
aws ecr create-repository --repository-name referpeople/education-backend --region ap-south-1
# (repeat for auth, masteradmin, and all 5 frontends)
```

STEP 2 -- Create EKS Cluster (15-20 min)

```
eksctl create cluster \
--name referpeople-cluster \
--region ap-south-1 \
--node-type t3.medium \
--nodes 3 --nodes-min 2 --nodes-max 5 --managed
kubectl get nodes # verify all 3 nodes are Ready
```

STEP 3 -- Create RDS PostgreSQL

```
aws rds create-db-instance \
--db-instance-identifier referpeople-db \
--db-instance-class db.t3.medium \
--engine postgres --engine-version 15.4 \
--master-username referpeople_admin \
--master-user-password 'YourSecurePassword123!' \
--allocated-storage 100 --multi-az
# After RDS is ready, create 6 databases:
psql -h -U referpeople_admin -c 'CREATE DATABASE referpeople_realestate;'
psql -h -U referpeople_admin -c 'CREATE DATABASE referpeople_loans;'
psql -h -U referpeople_admin -c 'CREATE DATABASE referpeople_jobs;'
psql -h -U referpeople_admin -c 'CREATE DATABASE referpeople_education;'
psql -h -U referpeople_admin -c 'CREATE DATABASE referpeople_auth;'
```

STEP 4 -- Build & Push Docker Images

```
AWS_ACCOUNT_ID=$(aws sts get-caller-identity --query Account --output text)
aws ecr get-login-password --region ap-south-1 | \
docker login --username AWS --password-stdin \
$AWS_ACCOUNT_ID.dkr.ecr.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com

SERVICES=(realestate-backend loans-backend jobs-backend education-backend
auth-backend realestate-frontend loans-frontend jobs-frontend education-frontend)
```

```
for SERVICE in ${SERVICES[@]}; do
docker build -t $SERVICE ./${SERVICE}/
docker tag $SERVICE:latest
$AWS_ACCOUNT_ID.dkr.ecr.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com/referpeople/$SERVICE:latest
docker push $AWS_ACCOUNT_ID.dkr.ecr.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com/referpeople/$SERVICE:latest
done
```

STEP 5 -- Deploy to Kubernetes

```
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/namespace.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/secrets.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/auth-backend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/realestate-backend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/loans-backend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/jobs-backend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/education-backend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/realestate-frontend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/loans-frontend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/jobs-frontend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/education-frontend.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/nginx.yaml
kubectl apply -f aws-deployment/k8s/ingress.yaml
kubectl get pods -n referpeople # wait for all to be Running
```

STEP 6 -- Run Migrations & Create Super Admin

```
for SVCNAME in auth-backend realestate-backend loans-backend jobs-backend education-backend; do
kubectl exec -it deployment/$SVCNAME -n referpeople -- python manage.py migrate
done
```

```
# Create super admin
kubectl exec -it deployment/auth-backend -n referpeople -- python manage.py shell
>>> from apps.accounts.models import User
>>> User.objects.create_superuser('superadmin@referpeople.in', 'SuperAdmin@2024')
>>> exit()
```


8. DNS Setup for referpeople.in

DNS Records to Create at Your Domain Registrar

After your ALB is created, get its DNS name with: `kubectl get ingress -n referpeople`. Then add these records at GoDaddy / Namecheap / BigRock / Cloudflare:

Record Type	Host / Name	Value	TTL
A	@	ALB IP or use ALIAS to ALB DNS	300
A	www	ALB IP or use ALIAS to ALB DNS	300
CNAME	api	referpeople.in	300
TXT	@	v=spf1 include:amazonses.com ~all	300
MX	@	mail.referpeople.in (priority 10)	300

Route 53 Setup (Recommended)

```
# Create hosted zone
aws route53 create-hosted-zone --name referpeople.in --caller-reference 'rp-$(date +%s)'

# Copy the 4 NS nameserver records to your domain registrar
# Then create A record alias pointing to ALB:
aws route53 change-resource-record-sets --hosted-zone-id YOUR_ZONE_ID \
--change-batch file://dns-records.json
```

SSL Certificate (Free via AWS ACM)

```
aws acm request-certificate \
--domain-name referpeople.in \
--subject-alternative-names www.referpeople.in *.referpeople.in \
--validation-method DNS \
--region ap-south-1

# Add the CNAME records shown in ACM console to Route 53
# Certificate auto-renews -- no maintenance needed
```

9. Git Branch Strategy

Branch Structure

```
main <- Production (deploys to referpeople.in)
|-- develop <- Staging / QA (integration branch)
|-- feature/realestate-property-search
|-- feature/loans-emi-calculator
|-- feature/jobs-application-flow
|-- feature/education-admission-portal
|-- feature/brand-colors-referpeople
```

Hotfixes from main:

```
-- hotfix/critical-login-bug
-- hotfix/payment-gateway-fix
```

Branch	Purpose	Deploys To	Protection Rules
main	Production code only	AWS EKS Production (referpeople.in)	PR + 1 approval + passing CI
develop	Integration and QA	AWS EKS Staging	PR + passing CI
feature/*	New features	Local dev only	None
hotfix/*	Emergency fixes	Production via main	Merge to main + develop
release/*	Release prep	Staging QA	Passing tests

Git Setup Commands

```
# Clone the existing repo and rename for referpeople
git clone https://github.com/vizz-bob/BRD_FINAL.git referpeople-platform
cd referpeople-platform

# Rename master to main if needed
git branch -m master main
git push -u origin main

# Create developer branch
git checkout -b develop
git push -u origin develop

# Start first feature
git checkout develop
git checkout -b feature/realestate-transformation

# Commit convention
git commit -m 'feat(realestate): add property search with location filter'
git commit -m 'feat(loans): integrate EMI calculator'
git commit -m 'style(theme): apply ReferPeople brand colors'
git commit -m 'chore(docker): update compose for new services'
```

10. GitHub Actions CI/CD Pipeline

File: .github/workflows/deploy-production.yml

```
name: Deploy to Production (referpeople.in)

on:
  push:
    branches: [main]

env:
  AWS_REGION: ap-south-1
  EKS_CLUSTER: referpeople-cluster
  ECR_REGISTRY: ${ secrets.AWS_ACCOUNT_ID }.dkr.ecr.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com

jobs:
  test:
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    steps:
      - uses: actions/checkout@v4
      - run: |
        cd realestate-backend && pip install -r requirements.txt
        python manage.py test --keepdb

  build-and-push:
    needs: test
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    steps:
      - uses: actions/checkout@v4
      - uses: aws-actions/configure-aws-credentials@v4
    with:
      aws-access-key-id: ${ secrets.AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID }
      aws-secret-access-key: ${ secrets.AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY }
      aws-region: ${ env.AWS_REGION }
      - uses: aws-actions/amazon-ecr-login@v2
      - run: |
        SERVICES=(realestate-backend loans-backend jobs-backend education-backend ...)
        for SERVICE in ${SERVICES[@]}; do
        docker build -t $ECR_REGISTRY/referpeople/$SERVICE:${ github.sha } ./ $SERVICE/
        docker push $ECR_REGISTRY/referpeople/$SERVICE:${ github.sha }
        done

  deploy:
    needs: build-and-push
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    steps:
      - run: aws eks update-kubeconfig --name referpeople-cluster
      - run: |
        kubectl set image deployment/realestate-backend ...
        kubectl rollout status deployment/realestate-backend -n referpeople
        echo 'Deployed to referpeople.in!'
```

11. All Required Files -- Deployment Checklist

Backend Files (per service -- 6 total)

- manage.py
- requirements.txt -- Django, djangorestframework, simplejwt, psycopg2-binary, redis, celery, django-axes, Pillow, boto3
- Dockerfile
- docker-entrypoint.sh -- Wait for DB, run migrate, collectstatic, start gunicorn
- .env.example -- Template with all required vars
- settings.py -- DB, JWT, CORS, AXES, INSTALLED_APPS
- urls.py -- Route to app URLs
- wsgi.py
- apps/accounts/models.py -- Custom User model (UUID primary key, email-based)
- apps/accounts/serializers.py, views.py, urls.py
- apps/tenants/models.py -- Tenant model with tenant_type choices
- apps/[service]/models.py -- Service-specific models (properties, loans, jobs, courses)
- apps/[service]/serializers.py, views.py, urls.py, admin.py, permissions.py
- apps/rbac/ -- Role, Permission, RolePermission, UserRole models

Frontend Files (per service -- 5 total)

- package.json -- react, react-dom, react-router-dom, axios, tailwindcss
- vite.config.js
- tailwind.config.js
- Dockerfile -- Build React app, serve with nginx
- nginx.conf -- Serve built files, proxy /api/ to backend
- .env.example -- VITE_API_BASE_URL, VITE_AUTH_URL
- public/logo.png, favicon.ico
- src/main.jsx, App.jsx
- src/theme/colors.js -- ReferPeople brand colors
- src/api/client.js -- Axios instance with JWT interceptor + refresh logic
- src/context/AuthContext.jsx -- Global auth state (login, logout, user)
- src/pages/ -- All page components
- src/components/Navbar.jsx -- With links to all 4 service pages
- src/components/Footer.jsx

Infrastructure Files

- docker-compose.yml -- All 11 containers defined

- docker-compose.override.yml -- Local dev: DEBUG=True, local DB ports
- .gitignore -- Includes .env, node_modules, __pycache__, *.key, *.cert
- Makefile -- make start / stop / migrate / build / test
- start-referpeople.sh -- One-command local startup
- nginx/conf.d/referpeople.conf -- Nginx routing for all 4 services
- aws-deployment/k8s/namespace.yaml
- aws-deployment/k8s/secrets.yaml -- DB credentials (base64 encoded)
- aws-deployment/k8s/[service]-backend.yaml x6 -- K8s deployments
- aws-deployment/k8s/[service]-frontend.yaml x5 -- K8s deployments
- aws-deployment/k8s/ingress.yaml -- ALB Ingress for referpeople.in
- .github/workflows/deploy-production.yml -- CI/CD to EKS
- .github/workflows/deploy-developer.yml -- CI/CD to staging
- referpeople-shared/theme/colors.css, colors.js -- Brand colors

12. Default Login Credentials (Change After Deploy!)

Role	Email	Password	Login URL
Super Admin	superadmin@referpeople.in	SuperAdmin@2024#Change!	referpeople.in/super-admin/
Master Admin	masteradmin@referpeople.in	MasterAdmin@2024!	referpeople.in/master-admin/
RE Tenant	reTenant@referpeople.in	Tenant@2024!	referpeople.in/tenant/login/
Loans Tenant	loansTenant@referpeople.in	Tenant@2024!	referpeople.in/loans/tenant/
Normal User	user@referpeople.in	User@2024!	referpeople.in/login/

IMPORTANT SECURITY STEPS

- Change ALL default passwords immediately after first deployment
- Generate a new SECRET_KEY: `python -c "import secrets; print(secrets.token_urlsafe(50))"`
- Never commit .env files to Git -- they are in .gitignore
- Enable MFA on your AWS account
- Restrict RDS security group to only accept connections from EKS nodes
- Rotate AWS access keys every 90 days
- Enable CloudTrail for audit logging

13. Troubleshooting Guide

Problem: CORS errors when frontend calls API

- In backend settings.py, add your domain to CORS_ALLOWED_ORIGINS
- Move corsheaders.middleware.CorsMiddleware to FIRST position in MIDDLEWARE
- Also add it to INSTALLED_APPS: 'corsheaders'

Problem: JWT 401 Unauthorized errors

- Add token refresh interceptor in src/api/client.js
- On 401 response, call /api/auth/token/refresh/ with the refresh token
- Store new access_token in localStorage and retry the original request

Problem: Pods CrashLoopBackOff in Kubernetes

- Run: kubectl logs deployment/realstate-backend -n referpeople --previous
- Check if DB_HOST in secrets.yaml matches your actual RDS endpoint
- Verify all required env vars are present with: kubectl describe pod -n referpeople

Problem: Nginx 502 Bad Gateway

- Backend containers may not be ready -- check: kubectl get pods -n referpeople
- Verify nginx can reach backend: kubectl exec deployment/nginx -n referpeople -- curl http://realstate-backend:8000/api/health/
- Check that container names in nginx.conf match docker-compose service names

Problem: Domain referpeople.in not resolving

- DNS propagation takes 24-48 hours after changing nameservers
- Check with: nslookup referpeople.in 8.8.8.8
- Verify A records point to correct ALB IP

Problem: Django migrations fail

- Run: kubectl exec -it deployment/realstate-backend -n referpeople -- python manage.py showmigrations
- Apply manually: python manage.py migrate apps.properties
- If migration conflict: python manage.py migrate --fake-initial

ReferPeople.in

"Find Property. Get Loans. Land Jobs. Start Learning."

Platform	ReferPeople.in v2.0
Domain	referpeople.in
Services	Real Estate Loans Jobs Education
Stack	Django REST + React 19 + PostgreSQL + Redis + AWS EKS
Date	May 2026